

SHOWCASE

Riptide R1X

Following the recent trend of putting motors on anything with wheels, electric skateboards have been seeing growing demand over the last couple of years.

While the Riptide R1X isn't exactly new, it has seen rising popularity since a demonstration at CES 2019, which is where it caught our attention. Boasting a range of roughly 22kms (nearly twice as its previous versions) at 35Km/h, the Riptide R1X seems like an incredibly fun-to-ride shortboard. All of that is powered by a 1800W dual belt drive with a 3:1 gear ratio, deep-toothed 15M belts, and hardened pulleys. Keep in mind that the actual top speed achievable on these things vary by the incline and gradient of the road and a few other factors.

It's not all about speed though, it's about control as well. Featuring a Rosewood build, the R1X comes with regenerative braking through its RX Remote. To roll on, it comes equipped with 90mm 74a ABEC11 ReFly Wheels, which Riptide describes to "feel like snowboarding". Along with that, you get head and tail lights from ShredLights, which can be set to bright, dim, or blink, depending on your riding style. It takes

about 3.5 hours to charge the unit so you might want to plan your ripping sessions in advance.

Apart from the tech smarts, the design has also seen an overhaul focussed on usability. There's an integrated kick tail at the back that makes turning and manual stops easy and controllable. The dual handles make carrying it around quite convenient, and at about 6.5 kgs, you'd do that without breaking a sweat. At its longest, the board is 31", and 9.5" at its widest, with a mere 4.5" rise over the ground, making it inconspicuous.



So you don't really need to worry about charging it at the coffee shop while you enjoy your coffee (or tea, we don't judge). The redesigned RX remote features a larger roller thumb wheel for better control over your acceleration and braking. Bright LEDs on the remote also indicate speed modes and battery levels. With all the smarts and power, the Riptide R1X will set you back a smooth \$999, shipping not included.

Hermès Arceau L'Heure De La Lune

The name Hermès brings up the image of designer handbags more than watches. However, in the past, the French high-fashion luxury goods manufacturer has made a name for itself by releasing notable timepieces and it repeated that feat this year at SIHH 2019. The Arceau L'Heure De La Lune takes the idea of the classic moon-phase watch and turns it on its head, quite literally in some ways.

You get the option for a grey meteorite or starry, blue aventurine for the dial, which is framed by the 43mm white gold case. Both the options come with the all-new Hermès Caliber H1837 movement. This movement is driven by a patent-pending module that powers the unique timekeeping mechanism and moon phase display on this watch.

There are two distinct subdials that display the time and date separately. Instead of having some rotation mechanism that makes a depiction of the moon rotate along with the phase, the De La Lune has the subdials rotate, floating above two mother-of-pearl moons that depict the moon phase for



the northern and the southern hemisphere individually. Hermès has flipped the convention by keeping the moon representing the southern hemisphere at 12'o clock, and the one for the northern hemisphere at 6'o clock, so you quite literally have to dive headfirst into this mechanism. The subdials, which come in black on the grey dial and white on the blue one, rotate across the dial clockwise, covering and revealing the lunar disks in accordance with the current moon phase in each hemisphere. This leads to a complete sweep in 59 days. This cosmic complication has been designed by Jean-Francois Mojon, who has worked with a host of brands, including MB&F and Harry Winston. The moon faces themselves are unique, with the one at 6'o clock representing the lunar surface whereas the one up at 12'o clock embracing a pegasus motif, inspired by the Pleine Lune (Full Moon) works of artist Dmitri Rybaltchenko.

The Hermès Arceau L'Heure de la Lune is limited to 100 pieces in each dial version, each priced at \$25,500; Hermès says they will be available at retail in Spring of 2019.